LS-CAT Management Board Meeting

Connection Instructions

Meeting URL

https://northwestern.zoom.us/j/95046156782

By Phone: 312-626-6799

Meeting ID: 950 4615 6782

Agenda

1:45	Sound Check / Informal Greetings
2:00	Welcome: Minutes and Agenda Approval (Stuckey)
2:10	Budget Forecast/New LS-CAT Agreement/SBC (Brister)
2:30	APS/APS-U Update (Mills)
2:50	LS-CAT Status Update (Brister)
3:15	New Business
3:30	Adjourn

Budget Forecast for FY 2022

FY 2022 contains three critical dates that may have budget implications:

1. October 15, 2021: Brister retires
2. February 28, 2022: Current LS-CAT Agreement Ends
3. June-ish, 2022: APS dark period starts (or will it be January-ish 2023?)

In any case there will be at least most of a full year of running with, hopefully, the current membership so a normal budget will be proposed in May 2021 with the observation that a mid-year correction may be needed.

New LS-CAT Agreement

Draft agreement circulated to the management board

Key features:

- No need to sign sequentially on the same signature page which hopefully speeds up the acceptance process
- New members can join the with the Joinder Agreement simplifying membership changes
- Associate CAT Member policy now part of the agreement
- Membership shares (both whole and fractional) supported
- Management board votes weighted by number of shares
- In-kind payments allowed allowed in lieu of direct payments. Personnel under this plan require approval of Manager to whom they will report for LS-CAT related duties

Only minor changes to the draft text have been identified to date.

SBC at LS-CAT

LS-CAT and APS management are continuing discussions that would bring the MX portion of a newly configured SBC to LS-CAT at the 1 or 2 share level.

Notes:

- There is nothing in writing.
- This would not start until after the dark period.
- Unlikely that money changes hands. This would entail payment in kind.

Mills presentation goes here.

Operations during a pandemic

Our main strategy for minimizing the risk to our staff and to our program is to minimize the number of LS-CAT staff working on-site. Nominally we operate in “weekend” mode with one staff member performing user support who can call in one person to help with repairs as needed.

However, the APS-U project requires us to vacate our offices as well as perform some other work which requires additional 1-2 people on-site. We do our best to to avoid contact with each other while on-site and so far we’ve avoided problems.

21-ID-D Mono Refurbishment

Over the past couple of years mechanical problems with the 21-ID-D monochromator have prevented us from providing an interface that allows users to change energy. Indeed, even the staff have found it difficult to change energy manually.

Additionally, the wiring has been exposed to high levels of x-ray radiation for years embrittling the insulation and making work on the mechanical problems difficult or impossible.

Prior to the pandemic we had contracted with the manufacture to replace the motors and the wiring as well as to restore the mechanics. The manufacturer's engineers are not allowed to travel to the US pausing the project. Since the situation is desperate we will go ahead and perform the work ourselves (with the manufacturer's detailed instructions) during the January 2021 down period.

Update on Brister Retirement

Planned last day is October 15, 2021, barring a compelling reason to choose a different date.

Search for a replacement should be underway by March 2021.

We should have an idea of who is signing the new LS-CAT agreement and for how many shares before interviewing applicants.

New Business